Ian Douglas

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Dear Hiring Team,

I'm a platform and security engineer with 12+ years building secure, code-driven infrastructure across Kubernetes, AWS, Azure, GCP, and bare metal. I'm applying for this role because I'm impressed by your company and because I believe my skills and experience would be a valuable asset to your team.

Platform as a product, at scale. At Pearson I built and operated Bitesize, a self-managed Kubernetes platform on AWS serving 400 development teams and proven under 8.5 million concurrent users at sub-250 ms. We delivered the platform itself continuously: 14 independently versioned components, from the VPC to the API server, composed into platform releases and promoted by 121 GitHub Actions jobs through eight clusters to two production regions, gated by tests, human approvals, and automated ServiceNow changes. I also co-developed Go operators and CRDs that provisioned AWS VPCs and databases from Kubernetes before AWS offered its own controllers. Releases went from one or two a year to several a day (case study).

Platforms as software. I've shipped Kubernetes platforms as versioned releases through Git-driven automation ever since. At ZagTech I created a la carte-as-code, a radically simple Terraform design for ordering complex clusters from a menu (Kate's Kitchen). At Invitae I automated Flux across multi-project, multi-environment cluster fleets for a petabyte-scale genomics platform.

Identity and security. At Stanford I helped move the university's authentication stack (SAML/Shibboleth, Kerberos, OpenLDAP) onto Kubernetes and ran multi-tenant Vault PKI. I also architected a zero-trust Active Directory whose domain controllers stay invisible until clients establish IPsec with ephemeral Vault certificates. Today I co-run a consultancy building Terraform-based Zero Trust capability packages modeled on NIST SP 800-207.

AI-accelerated engineering. I use agentic tools like Claude Code to ship production automation fast; at The Motley Fool, that meant Python tooling that migrated about 200 repositories from Jenkins to GitHub Actions. I also build tooling for AI and data workflows: Context Forge shrinks codebases by role and caches them in Gemini so coding assistants can write against large libraries, and Dataset Pipeline turns raw market data into optimized Parquet for large-scale backtesting.

I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I can contribute to your mission and how I might benefit the team.

Sincerely,

Ian Douglas